rolling conflicts

In a conflict, players roll a triple dice pool

☐ Discipline + ■ Exhaustion + ■ Madness

against the GM's dice pool of

■ Pain

Always roll all dice on the character sheet

The player may — before the roll —
add +1-6 Madness dice

The player may — before or after the roll —
add +1 Exhaustion die by taking +1 Exhaustion

The player may — after the roll —
add a ⚀ in Discipline by spending –1 Hope

The GM may — after the roll —
add or remove a ⚅ in any pool by converting –1 Despair to +1 Hope

Success

Each ⚀⚁⚂ wins +1 Success for its pool

An action succeeds if the player's total Successes from their triple pool meet or exceed GM Pain Successes

Dominant pool

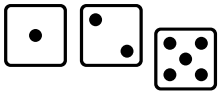
Each pool's Strength is its highest die

Break ties with the next-highest die, then Discipline > Madness > Exhaustion > Pain

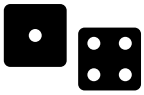
The pool with the highest Strength dominates the situation, producing consequences

Example

Discipline



Exhaustion



Madness

Pain

The player's 3 Successes (2 from Discipline, 1 from Exhaustion) beat the GM's 2 (from Pain) so their character's action succeeds

Pain's Strength of 6-5 dominates — beating Madness' Strength of 6-4 — so the character pays a greater price for their action than they anticipated

☐ Discipline — white dice

When dominant

The situation stays under control

The player may un-check either —

- A Response
- –1 Exhaustion

■ Exhaustion — black dice

When dominant

The situation taxes the character's resources and confronts them with their need to rest

Add +1 Exhaustion — if now over 6, they Crash

Using an Exhaustion talent

To do the difficult

The character must have Exhaustion

Get a minimum of Exhaustion in Successes

To do the impossible

The player must add +1 Exhaustion

Get +1 Success / Exhaustion

■ Madness — red dice

When dominant

The situation becomes chaotic

The player picks a Response to check off and roleplay

If the character lacks un-checked Responses they Snap

Using a Madness talent

The player must add Madness dice

Use more dice for more powerful effects

■ Pain — gray dice

When dominant

The character pays a greater price for their action than they anticipated

Add +1 Despair coin to the coffer

Failure

*When Pain Successes beat player Successes the GM **may** choose either —*

- Add +1 Exhaustion
  (unavailable if Exhaustion dominates)
- A Response to check off and roleplay
  (unavailable if Madness dominates)

These may cause a Snap or Crash

Snap

When a character must check a Response but had none remaining

- The character freaks out for the rest of this scene or all of the next scene (at least!)
- Uncheck all Responses
- Convert –1 Discipline to +1 Madness
- If this reduces Discipline to 0, the character becomes a NPC Nightmare

Crash

When a character's Exhaustion exceeds 6

By the end of the scene they fall asleep for at least a day ... or die

Sleep

Sleeping characters attract Nightmares

When a character wakes from sleep

- Discipline = 1
- Exhaustion = 0
- Responses are all un-checked
- The character may not use talents

After staying awake for as long as they slept

- Discipline = 3
- The character may use talents

Helping other characters

- Narrate the helping action
- Roll the helper's Discipline dice
- Use the Successes from those dice
- Do **not** use those Discipline dice in determining which pool dominates

Casting A Shadow

After rolling a conflict the GM may

- Add or remove a ⚅ in any pool by ...
- Convert –1 Despair to +1 Hope
  (this Hope is unavailable until next scene)

If this makes Pain dominate
that does **not** add a coin to the Despair coffer

Shedding light

Hope coins vanish at session end

Players may ...

Get A Break

When not in a conflict

- Spend –1 Hope
- Un-check their choice of either:
  - A Response
  - –1 Exhaustion

Improve Success

After a roll but before results are narrated

- Spend –1 Hope
- Add a ⚀ to the Discipline pool

Restore Discipline

After the character relaxes for a few hours

- Spend –[5-Discipline] Hope
- Convert –1 Madness to +1 Discipline

Scars

Characters record one key experience at the end of each session as a new Scar

Players may ...

Recall A Scar

- Check the Scar off for the session
- Re-roll Discipline, Madness, or Exhaustion

Transform A Scar

- Cross the Scar off permanently
- Choose one —
  - Add +5 Hope
  - Transform a madness talent into a different one for the duration of the scene
  - Transform a madness talent into a different one permanently